GRINDSTONE WRESTLING

2026-27 season quickstart

Your weekly practice

2026-27 season | Updated October 28, 2026
From the club's season handout. All times are local; TeamSnap carries changes and cancellations.

Program	Days	Time	School
Mat Rats - Black	Monday, Wednesday, Friday	6:00-8:00 p.m.	Westminster High School
Mat Rats - Blue	Tuesday, Thursday	6:00-8:00 p.m.	Westminster High School
Pups	Tuesday	6:00-7:00 p.m.	Winters Mill High School
Valkyries	Monday, Wednesday, Friday	6:30-8:00 p.m.	Winters Mill High School

Westminster High School | 1225 Washington Road, Westminster, MD 21157.
Mat Rats Black and Blue: use the **main entrance or concert entrance**.

Winters Mill High School | 560 Gorsuch Road, Westminster, MD 21157.
Pups and Valkyries: use the **rear wrestling-room entrance by the baseball fields** - **Door 28**.

Before and after practice

- Check TeamSnap before leaving. Arrive early enough to change shoes and be ready at the start.
- Pack athletic clothes, a labeled water bottle, wrestling shoes and headgear.
- **Registration does not include practice gear.** If your family needs help, contact a coach early about donated shoes or headgear. Supplies and sizes are limited; availability is not guaranteed.
- Keep wrestling shoes off outdoor surfaces. Keep street shoes off the mats. Change at the room and remove jewelry.
- Keep nails trimmed. Tell the coach about an injury, illness or skin concern before contact; use the health guide for next steps.
- After training, shower and clean used clothing and gear. Encourage effort and ask what your wrestler enjoyed or learned.

Get every caregiver connected

Complete your child's TeamSnap profile, including the photo requested by the club. Keep personal details in the team system.

1. Accept the club's invitation and check that you can open the correct team and season.

2. Add each authorized caregiver who handles transport or updates - including a grandparent when appropriate - to the athlete's contacts. Each caregiver uses their own access.

3. Have each caregiver open the next practice, read a team message and check their notification settings. Ask for help before relying on forwarded messages.

TeamSnap setup and troubleshooting. No access yet? Contact grindstonewrestlingmd@gmail.com.

Competition depends on your program

Mat Rats: Practices are expected. Families may **opt out of MMWL competition entirely**; tell the coaches so rosters reflect that choice. Otherwise, athletes are expected at **every MMWL event for which they are eligible**. For individual meet absences, opt out by **end of day Tuesday before the event**; report practice absences as soon as known. Caregivers and athletes must tell coaches and **update TeamSnap availability**. Chat, direct message, email or an in-person conversation is welcome, but does not replace that update. For emergencies or late changes, communicate and update availability promptly. Coaches manage rosters and last-minute adjustments.

Valkyries: Compete in the **Mason-Dixon Wrestling League (MDWL)**. Athletes must participate in **at least 5 meets** to compete at the end of the season. Confirm event choices with Valkyries coaches; the Mat Rats opt-out expectation does not apply.

Pups: The introductory clinic does not include competitions.

For a meet, confirm arrival/check-in, uniform and equipment, and where to find your coach. Check with the coach before leaving. Encourage your child, let coaches coach and let officials handle the match.

Keep the full family guide handy

Family guides cover meet day, scoring, spectator expectations and health concerns. Ask the club about current registration, forms and ways to help.

Full guide and current links
packetbench.github.io/grindstone-guide/#families

This companion includes coach-confirmed practice and competition guidance. MMWL means Mid-Maryland Wrestling League; MDWL means Mason-Dixon Wrestling League. Follow current club and event instructions for additional eligibility requirements, deposits and volunteer commitments.